
KEY
GREEK FLEET
30–40 Greek triremes
PERSIAN FLEET
40–50 large Persian warships
1 EARLY MORNING
The Persian fleet blocks the eastern exit from the Salamis channel. Expecting the Greeks to try to escape, they have spent the night on patrol or on watch for Greek ships. The Greeks, however, are well rested after spending the night ashore.
Xerxes sets up his throne on slopes of Mount Aegaleos to watch the battle
XERXES' THRONE
Salamis Channel
GREEK MAINLAND
The Greeks, after spending the night moored outside the town of Salamis, move out to attack the Persians
Port of Piraeus
Salamis
Paloukia Bay
Main Persian force watches for Greek ships attempting to escape the blockade
PSYTTALIA
The Greeks have spent the night moored in Paloukia Bay
ISLAND OF SALAMIS
GULF OF AEGINA
2 THE PERSIAN PURSUIT
The Persians are lured into the narrow strait between the island of Salamis and the mainland. Despite their overwhelming numerical superiority, the size of their ships is now a handicap and they are at the mercy of the nimbler Greek triremes.
Salamis Channel
XERXES' THRONE
Greek left wing, having advanced further than they intended, row back into the Salamis Channel
GREEK MAINLAND
Persians are lured into the channel, as they follow the apparently retreating Greeks
Port of Piraeus
Salamis
Paloukia Bay
PSYTTALIA
Greek right wing consists of Spartans and other allies of the Athenians. The ships remain close to shore, hidden from view
Persian fleet splits in two to round island at entrance of channel
ISLAND OF SALAMIS
GULF OF AEGINA
3 GREEK COUNTERATTACK
In the narrow channel, the smaller Greek triremes outmaneuver the Persians, making devastating use of their rams. At least 200 Persian warships are sunk, while the Greeks lose only 40 of their triremes.
Salamis Channel
XERXES' THRONE
GREEK MAINLAND
Port of Piraeus
Greek left wing draws leading Persian ships into narrow part of the strait, then turns to engage in fierce battle of ramming and boarding. Persian commander is killed and right wing crumbles
Greek right wing attacks Persian flank as the enemy ships row up the channel, successfully sinking many of them by ramming
PSYTTALIA
Very few Persian ships are able to withdraw
The narrow channels on either side of the island of Psyttalia become clogged with Persian ships
GULF OF AEGINA